

Given a permutation of the nodes $\sigma = (\sigma_1, \dots, \sigma_d)$ and some score vector $\mathbf{s} = (s_1, \dots, s_d)$ for the nodes, we define the likelihood of the permutation under this score as

$$\log P_{PL}(\sigma; \mathbf{s}) = \log P_{PL}(\sigma_1, \dots, \sigma_d; \mathbf{s}) = \sum_{j=1}^d \left[\log s(\sigma_j) - \log \left(\sum_{k=j}^d s(\sigma_k) \right) \right] \quad (1)$$

Given a dataset $\mathcal{D} = \left\{ \left(X_1^{(i)}, \dots, X_d^{(i)} \right) \right\}_{i=1}^N$ and a flow model f_θ , which takes a row of the data and a permutation as input and outputs the log-likelihood of observing that row under this permutation, we define the likelihood of $\mathcal{D}$ as follows:

$$\log P(\mathcal{D}; \theta; \mathbf{s}) = \sum_{i=1}^N \log P(X_1^{(i)}, \dots, X_d^{(i)}; \theta; \mathbf{s}) \quad (2)$$

$$= \sum_{i=1}^N \log \mathbb{E}_{\sigma \sim P_{PL}(\cdot; \mathbf{s})} \left[P(X_1^{(i)}, \dots, X_d^{(i)}; \theta; \sigma) \right] \quad (3)$$

$$= \sum_{i=1}^N \log \mathbb{E}_{\sigma \sim P_{PL}(\cdot; \mathbf{s})} \left[\exp \left\{ f_\theta \left(X_1^{(i)}, \dots, X_d^{(i)}; \sigma \right) \right\} \right] \quad (4)$$

Now, let's derive the maximum-likelihood estimation of parameters $\{\theta, \mathbf{s}\}$. We run a gradient-based optimization to find the best parameters:

$$\nabla_\theta \log P(\mathcal{D}; \theta; \mathbf{s}) = \sum_{i=1}^N \nabla_\theta \log P(X_1^{(i)}, \dots, X_d^{(i)}; \theta; \mathbf{s}) \quad (5)$$

$$= \sum_{i=1}^N \nabla_\theta \log \mathbb{E}_{\sigma \sim P_{PL}(\cdot; \mathbf{s})} \left[P(X_1^{(i)}, \dots, X_d^{(i)}; \theta; \sigma) \right] \quad (6)$$

$$= \sum_{i=1}^N \frac{\mathbb{E}_{\sigma \sim P_{PL}(\cdot; \mathbf{s})} \left[\nabla_\theta \exp \left\{ f_\theta \left(X_1^{(i)}, \dots, X_d^{(i)}; \sigma \right) \right\} \right]}{\mathbb{E}_{\sigma \sim P_{PL}(\cdot; \mathbf{s})} \left[\exp \left\{ f_\theta \left(X_1^{(i)}, \dots, X_d^{(i)}; \sigma \right) \right\} \right]} \quad (7)$$

$$= \sum_{i=1}^N \frac{\mathbb{E}_{\sigma \sim P_{PL}(\cdot; \mathbf{s})} \left[\nabla_\theta f_\theta \left(X_1^{(i)}, \dots, X_d^{(i)}; \sigma \right) \cdot \exp \left\{ f_\theta \left(X_1^{(i)}, \dots, X_d^{(i)}; \sigma \right) \right\} \right]}{\mathbb{E}_{\sigma \sim P_{PL}(\cdot; \mathbf{s})} \left[\exp \left\{ f_\theta \left(X_1^{(i)}, \dots, X_d^{(i)}; \sigma \right) \right\} \right]} \quad (8)$$

$$\nabla_{\mathbf{s}} \log P(\mathcal{D}; \theta; \mathbf{s}) = \sum_{i=1}^N \nabla_{\mathbf{s}} \log P(X_1^{(i)}, \dots, X_d^{(i)}; \theta; \mathbf{s}) \quad (9)$$

$$= \sum_{i=1}^N \nabla_{\mathbf{s}} \log \mathbb{E}_{\sigma \sim P_{PL}(\cdot; \mathbf{s})} \left[\exp \left\{ f_\theta \left(X_1^{(i)}, \dots, X_d^{(i)}; \sigma \right) \right\} \right] \quad (10)$$

$$= \sum_{i=1}^N \frac{\mathbb{E}_{\sigma \sim P_{PL}(\cdot; \mathbf{s})} \left[\nabla_{\mathbf{s}} \log P_{PL}(\sigma; \mathbf{s}) \cdot \exp \left\{ f_\theta \left(X_1^{(i)}, \dots, X_d^{(i)}; \sigma \right) \right\} \right]}{\mathbb{E}_{\sigma \sim P_{PL}(\cdot; \mathbf{s})} \left[\exp \left\{ f_\theta \left(X_1^{(i)}, \dots, X_d^{(i)}; \sigma \right) \right\} \right]} \quad (11)$$

where,

$$\nabla_{\mathbf{s}} \mathbb{E}_{\boldsymbol{\sigma} \sim P_{PL}(\cdot; \mathbf{s})} \left[\exp \left\{ f_{\theta} \left(X_1^{(i)}, \dots, X_d^{(i)}; \boldsymbol{\sigma} \right) \right\} \right] \quad (12)$$

$$= \nabla_{\mathbf{s}} \sum_{\boldsymbol{\sigma}} P_{PL}(\boldsymbol{\sigma}; \mathbf{s}) \cdot \left[\exp \left\{ f_{\theta} \left(X_1^{(i)}, \dots, X_d^{(i)}; \boldsymbol{\sigma} \right) \right\} \right] \quad (13)$$

$$= \sum_{\boldsymbol{\sigma}} \nabla_{\mathbf{s}} P_{PL}(\boldsymbol{\sigma}; \mathbf{s}) \cdot \left[\exp \left\{ f_{\theta} \left(X_1^{(i)}, \dots, X_d^{(i)}; \boldsymbol{\sigma} \right) \right\} \right] \quad (14)$$

$$= \sum_{\boldsymbol{\sigma}} P_{PL}(\boldsymbol{\sigma}; \mathbf{s}) \frac{\nabla_{\mathbf{s}} P_{PL}(\boldsymbol{\sigma}; \mathbf{s})}{P_{PL}(\boldsymbol{\sigma}; \mathbf{s})} \cdot \left[\exp \left\{ f_{\theta} \left(X_1^{(i)}, \dots, X_d^{(i)}; \boldsymbol{\sigma} \right) \right\} \right] \quad (15)$$

$$= \sum_{\boldsymbol{\sigma}} P_{PL}(\boldsymbol{\sigma}; \mathbf{s}) (\nabla_{\mathbf{s}} \log P_{PL}(\boldsymbol{\sigma}; \mathbf{s})) \cdot \left[\exp \left\{ f_{\theta} \left(X_1^{(i)}, \dots, X_d^{(i)}; \boldsymbol{\sigma} \right) \right\} \right] \quad (16)$$

$$= \mathbb{E}_{\boldsymbol{\sigma} \sim P_{PL}(\cdot; \mathbf{s})} \left[\nabla_{\mathbf{s}} \log P_{PL}(\boldsymbol{\sigma}; \mathbf{s}) \cdot \exp \left\{ f_{\theta} \left(X_1^{(i)}, \dots, X_d^{(i)}; \boldsymbol{\sigma} \right) \right\} \right] \quad (17)$$

Therefore, if we define our loss function as following:

$$\ell(\theta, \mathbf{s}) = \frac{1}{N} \sum_{i=1}^N \frac{\mathbb{E}_{\boldsymbol{\sigma} \sim P_{PL}(\cdot; \mathbf{s})} \left[\left(\log P_{PL}(\boldsymbol{\sigma}; \mathbf{s}) + f_{\theta} \left(X_1^{(i)}, \dots, X_d^{(i)}; \boldsymbol{\sigma} \right) \right) \cdot \text{sg} \left(\exp \left\{ f_{\theta} \left(X_1^{(i)}, \dots, X_d^{(i)}; \boldsymbol{\sigma} \right) \right\} \right) \right]}{\mathbb{E}_{\boldsymbol{\sigma} \sim P_{PL}(\cdot; \mathbf{s})} \left[\text{sg} \left(\exp \left\{ f_{\theta} \left(X_1^{(i)}, \dots, X_d^{(i)}; \boldsymbol{\sigma} \right) \right\} \right) \right]} \quad (18)$$

where sg means stop-gradient.